

Important Folders for Windows Update

C:\Windows\SoftwareDistribution (MOST IMPORTANT)

Purpose

- Main working folder for Windows Update
- Stores downloaded update files and update history

Important Subfolders

- **Download** → Actual update files (.cab, .msu)
- **DataStore** → Update database (update history)

Troubleshooting Use

- If Windows Update is stuck or failing, this folder is often **renamed or deleted**

```
net stop wuauserv
```

```
net stop bits
```

```
rename C:\Windows\SoftwareDistribution SoftwareDistribution.old
```

```
net start wuauserv
```

```
net start bits
```

 Safe to delete (Windows recreates it automatically)

C:\Windows\System32\catroot2

Purpose

- Stores **security catalog (.cat) files**
- Used to verify **update integrity and signatures**

Issue Scenario

- Corrupted catroot2 → update install fails

Fix

```
net stop cryptsvc
```

```
rename C:\Windows\System32\catroot2 catroot2.old
```

```
net start cryptsvc
```

C:\Windows\WinSxS (Windows Component Store)

Purpose

- Stores all Windows components and update versions
- Required for:
 - Rollback updates
 - Add/remove Windows features
 - System repair (SFC, DISM)

Cyber / Support Point

- Huge folder (normal behavior)
-  Never delete manually

Cleanup Command

```
DISM /Online /Cleanup-Image /StartComponentCleanup
```

C:\Windows\Logs\WindowsUpdate

Purpose

- Stores **Windows Update logs**
- Helps identify:
 - Error codes
 - Download/install failures

Common File

- WindowsUpdate.log (newer Windows versions generate it)

Generate log manually

Get-WindowsUpdateLog

5 C:\Windows\Logs\CBS

Purpose

- Component-Based Servicing logs
- Tracks update installation and system file repair

Important File

- CBS.log

Used when:

- Update fails
- SFC / DISM issues

6 C:\Windows\Temp

Purpose

- Temporary update files
- Setup remnants

Safe to clean (Admin permission required)

7 C:\Windows\Installer

Purpose

- Stores MSI installer data for:
 - Updates
 - Patches
 - Rollbacks

Do NOT delete

- Deleting breaks updates and installed software

Windows Update Related Services (Exam / Interview Point)

Service	Role
wuauserv	Windows Update
BITS	Background download
CryptSvc	Update verification
TrustedInstaller	Installs updates